



SALAAM-E-ISHQ

Production cost: **Rs 35 cr**

Total revenue: **Rs 53 cr**

Domestic box office (B.O.) revenue: **Rs 25 cr**

Overseas revenue: **Rs 10 cr**

PRE-SALE REVENUE

Satellite TV rights: **Rs 12 cr**

Music, home video: **Rs 5.5 cr**

In-film placement: **Rs 50 lakh**

Sources: Production studios and market estimates for pre-sale figures;
Boxofficeindia.com and IBOSnetwork.com for box office figures

■ By Malini Bhupta

The multi-starrer *Salaam-e-Ishq* may not have captured the imagination of critics and the audience in India, but the film's box office collections did not give producer Sunil Manchanda any sleepless nights. Even before the film hit theatres, Manchanda's MAD Films had sold the world rights for Rs 42 crore to entertainment powerhouse Eros International. After pocketing a neat profit of Rs 7 crore prior to the release of the film and another Rs 2.5 crore from the music, Manchanda was free to devote his energies to his next production, *Cheeni Kum*.

Of the 75-odd films released this year, 85 per cent bombed at the box office. Even tried and tested formula films from the Yash Raj banner—*Jhoom Barabar Jhoom* and *Tara Rum Pum*—flopped, according to *ibosnetwork.com*, a box office tracking website for Hindi films. The losses, however, amounting to about Rs 100 crore, were not borne by the producers. With corporate players like Adlabs, Studio18 and UTV entering the entertainment industry, the dynamics of filmmaking and distribution in Bollywood have undergone a significant change. The rule of thumb is to do what you are capable of, leaving the rest to experts. Banks are queuing up to fund Hindi films and finance is no longer dependent on the underworld. With the availability of many channels to exploit a film's potential, its success is no longer solely dependent on box office collections.

India is one of the largest media markets in the world and has the third largest cable and satellite reach. Almost 200 Hindi films are released in a year in the country's 12,500 single screens, 750 digital screens and 90-plus multiplexes, which house 380 screens. But theatrical revenue contributes only about 40 per cent of the total turnover of an average film, while it's 60 per cent for a blockbuster—a clear departure from the time when theatrical revenue accounted for 80 per cent of a film's earnings. "Despite higher ticket prices, the share of theatrical revenue is coming down," agrees Pritish Nandy, chairman, Pritish Nandy Communications.